

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1159

By Martin B

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate the Huntingdon High School Fillies girls' basketball team upon winning the 2026 TSSAA Division I, Class 2A state championship.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly should salute those student athletes who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true champions of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary group of young ladies is the Fillies girls' basketball team of Huntingdon High School, whose members have proven themselves to be the fiercest of competitors and truly worthy of admiration by winning the 2026 TSSAA Division I, Class 2A state championship; and

WHEREAS, the Fillies roster was not packed with experience when the season began, as it included six sophomores, four freshmen, and a lone senior; and

WHEREAS, despite their lack of experience, the 2025-2026 Fillies dominated the opposition, winning a school-record 31 games; after suffering their final loss on December 20, 2025, Huntingdon finished the season with a 21-game winning streak; and

WHEREAS, the Fillies began postseason play by winning the District 12-AA tournament, trouncing Waverly 78-29 in the semifinals and routing Camden 65-20 in the championship tilt; and

WHEREAS, at the Region 6-AA tournament, Huntingdon blasted Harpeth 91-26 in the quarterfinals, demolished Cheatham County 57-22 in the semifinals, and defeated Stewart County 54-47 in the final to claim the region title and earn a coveted home game in the sectional round; and

WHEREAS, facing off against Summertown in their sectional contest, Huntingdon posted a 20-point victory (65-45) to punch their ticket to The Glass House, home of the TSSAA Class 2A state tournament; and

WHEREAS, as the competition toughened, so did the Fillies; Huntingdon avenged one of only three losses all year by defeating Smith County 60-57 in the quarterfinals before vanquishing Gatlinburg-Pittman 65 42 in the semifinal round of the state tourney; and

WHEREAS, matching up against the always-tough York Institute in the title game, the Fillies slayed the Dragonettes 43-41 and raised the Gold Ball trophy as state champions; and

WHEREAS, the Fillies relied heavily upon the talent, leadership, and determination of their freshman phenom Wylie Kee throughout the season, and especially in the state tournament; and

WHEREAS, Wylie Kee averaged 19.4 points and 8.4 rebounds per game for the season, but truly spread her wings in the state tournament, scoring 54 points and pulling down 39 rebounds; and

WHEREAS, Wylie Kee's roundball prowess is self-evident, but she has also received numerous honors; she was named Most Valuable Player of the District 12-AA regular season, District 12-AA tournament, Region 6-AA tournament, and the Class 2A state tournament, and she was also named a Miss Basketball finalist this season; and

WHEREAS, Huntingdon's superb performance would not have been possible without the expert guidance of Coach David Wilkins; his assistants, Kelsey Perry and Cliff Kelley; and the unfailing support of the players' families, their fans, and their community; and

WHEREAS, Coach Wilkins has posted an outstanding overall record of 166-54 with three state tournament appearances during his seven years as head coach of the Fillies; the 2026 state title is his first, an accomplishment that should relieve some pressure within the Wilkins family, as his father and two brothers have won five state titles between them; and

WHEREAS, each of the Fillies players contributed significantly to the team's remarkable winning streak en route to the state title; these outstanding young ladies include the aforementioned Wylie Kee, All-State Tournament selection Ellie Wilson, the team's second-leading scorer Knox Bennett, Grier Bartholomew, Krystin Moore, Kaylen Cary, Millie Luther, Tatum Rich, Emalynn Maness, Ali Harris, and Maria Baretto de Vicente; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Huntingdon girls' basketball team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the Huntingdon Fillies for their championship season on the hardwood; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the Huntingdon High School Fillies girls' basketball team upon winning the 2026 TSSAA Division I, Class 2A state championship and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.